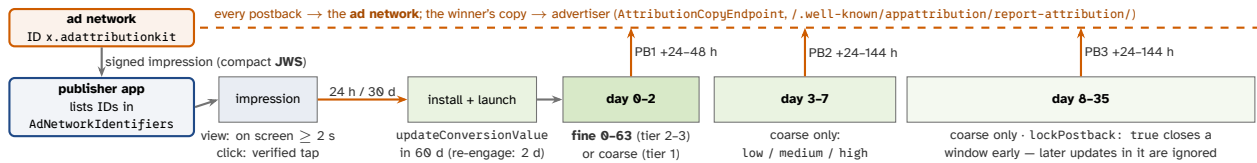


In one line: Two different systems. **ATT** is a *permission* for **tracking** — linking data from your app with *other companies'* data for ads or ad measurement, or sharing it with a data broker; unless the user taps Allow, the **IDFA is all zeros**. **AdAttributionKit** (iOS 17.4+, successor of SKAdNetwork) is measurement *without* permission: the **device** picks the winning ad and sends a **delayed, signed, crowd-anonymised postback** with no user or device ID.

AdAttributionKit — one ad, one winner, three delayed postbacks



Who wins: a click beats a view, then the most recent; ≤ 6 impressions considered; ONE winner across AdAttributionKit and SKAdNetwork. Up to 5 other networks get non-winning postbacks.

Crowd anonymity tiers 0-3 — the bigger the crowd, the more data: source-identifier 2 / 3 / 4 digits, fine value, publisher ID. Tier 0: no PB2/PB3. Country code needs a bonus tier (WWDC25).

ATT

- **Tracking** = the *linking*, whatever the identifier: ads targeted with other companies' data; e-mail lists / ad IDs to networks for retargeting; location to a broker; **an SDK in your app that combines your users' data with other apps'** — even if you don't use it that way. **Not tracking:** joins done *only on device*; a broker used solely for fraud / security; credit agencies.
- `ATTrackingManager.requestTrackingAuthorization` (callback or async) + `NSUserTrackingUsageDescription`; needed for the IDFA since **iOS 14.5**. Status: `notDetermined` · `restricted` · `denied` · `authorized`.
- **No prompt** — the completion runs at once — when the app is not `UIApplicationStateActive`, in an extension, tracking is restricted, the global “Allow Apps to Request to Track” is off, or a request is pending. Dismissed → `notDetermined`: ask later.
- **IDFA** (`ASIdentifierManager`): a UUID only when authorized; else (and in the Simulator) `00000000-...`. Re-read, never store. **IDFV** (`identifierForVendor`): one value per vendor per device; new after *all* the vendor's apps are deleted; nil after reboot until first unlock. First-party use only.
- **Fingerprinting is banned whatever the answer** (license agreement): no device ID derived from device / network / browser traits — an SDK doing it gets you rejected. **5.1.2(i)**: no gating, no reward for Allow; a primer may explain, never trick.
- **Tracking domains** (`NSPrivacyTrackingDomains`, iOS 17+): without consent, requests to them **fail** — keep tracking and non-tracking endpoints on separate hosts.
- **EU** (current docs): after an answer, no new prompt for a year; FR, DE, IT, PL, RO get a full-page sheet (`NSUserTrackingMarketingUsageDescription`, 27.2 beta).

Example — ask when active; report value without asking

```
// from an ACTIVE scene (after onboarding) - not didFinishLaunching
func idfaIfAllowed() async -> UUID? {
    let s = await ATTrackingManager.requestTrackingAuthorization()
    guard s == .authorized else { return nil } // zeros anyway
    return ASIdentifierManager.shared().advertisingIdentifier
}
// advertised app: at first launch, then per milestone. No ATT.
// the 6-bit fine value (0...63) is YOUR schema
func reached(_ fine: Int, big: Bool) async {
    try? await Postback.updateConversionValue(fine,
        coarseConversionValue: big ? .high : .low,
        lockPostback: false) // true = send this window now
}
```

AdAttributionKit

- **StoreKit-rendered** ads (`SKOverlay`, `SKStoreProductViewController` given the impression) record by themselves. **Custom-rendered:** `AppImpression(compactJWS:); click = UIEventAttributionView over the ad + handleTap()`

(throws without a real tap); `view = beginView()/endView()`, 26.2+ `handleView()`.

- **Rules** (WWDC25, Info.plist `AdAttributionKitConfigurations`): window view 1-7 d, click 1-30 d, global or per network; **cooldown** 0-720 h so a later ad can't steal a conversion.
- **Re-engagement** (iOS 18): `handleTap(reengagementURL:)` with the advertised app's **universal link** opens it; the query holds `Postback.reengagementOpenURLParameter`. **18.4:** overlapping re-engagement windows told apart by a **conversion tag** (`PostbackUpdate`); Settings can create development postbacks.
- **vs SKAdNetwork** (StoreKit, 11.3; v4.0 in 16.1 added 3 windows + coarse): App Store only, `SKAdNetworkItems`, `updatePostbackConversionValue`, copies to `/.well-known/skadnetwork/...` `AdAttributionKit` adds **alternative marketplaces** (EU), re-engagement, JWS. Network IDs work in both; SKAdNetwork updates are **mirrored** into it; Apple now recommends `AdAttributionKit`.

What teams actually do

- **Consented** users: IDFA to an MMP (mobile measurement partner), user-level attribution.
- **Everyone:** the network / MMP verifies each postback's signature and aggregates by campaign (source-identifier) server-side. The 6 bits are a designed schema (revenue buckets, funnel steps) with coarse mapped onto it; *lock early* = faster signal, less information.
- **Apple Ads:** `AAAtribution.attributionToken()` (`AdServices`, 14.3+), `POSTed` within 24 h.

Traps

- ! Asking in `didFinishLaunching`: not active yet → no prompt, nothing learned.
- ! “We use IDFV / hashed e-mail, so no ATT” — tracking is the *linking*, not the ID.
- ! “The SDK tracks, not us” — its behaviour is yours: ATT, label, manifest.
- ! Expecting per-user or real-time attribution — aggregate, 24 h+ late, tier-limited.
- ! No `updateConversionValue` at first launch — the conversion window never starts.
- ! ATT “Allow” is not GDPR consent — two separate duties.

Remember

“ATT asks before you link; AdAttributionKit counts without knowing who.” Windows **2 / 7 / 35** days; fine value only in the first; 6 bits.